

ODACON

Stars: Yellow / White / Blue Dwarf

Known for: Shadows of the Old war, Mining Station Echcron, Dying star, Ash belt of the destroyed planet Matush

Exports: Mineral resources

Imports: Medicine, Technology, Food

The Odacon system stands as a monument of destruction and a testament to the madness of the Portal wars. People do not travel here voluntarily, unless they are passing through while traversing the Miran chain, or are desperate enough to seek fame and fortune in the ruined system.

SHADOWS OF THE OLD WAR

Odacon was once a thriving and densely populated system, colonized and built by the Firstcome. Many of the worlds had prosperous cities and advanced industries. Then the First Portal War came. In the early stages, the system was fairly unaffected, but the end of the Wars brought total annihilation. The final and most destructive battles of the war were fought here and led to devastation on a scale never before seen in the history of the Third Horizon. The Order of the Pariah used its most sophisticated bionic constructs and antimatter weaponry, while others bombarded planets and asteroids with nuclear and chemical warheads. This resulted in the desolated and fragmented system Odacon is today.

THE ODACON SYSTEM

The system consists of three planets, as well as the scattered remains of a fourth. None of the planets have any substantial settlements. The navigational challenges involved, as well as the many dangers that lurk in the war-torn remains of Odacon space, make it economically unfeasible for the Factions to justify establishing a foothold in the system. Odacon has instead become a system where only truly adventurous free traders and other shadier enterprises operate.

OVERVIEW

Sethlan: Irradiated metal planet.

Mining Station Echcron: Mass accelerator for metal freight.

Rusah: Destroyed planet guarded by the Draconites.

Ash Belt: Obscures the star for the outer planets.

Khurshid: Burnt stone planet.

Qanya: Ice planet with a temple of the Order of the Pariah

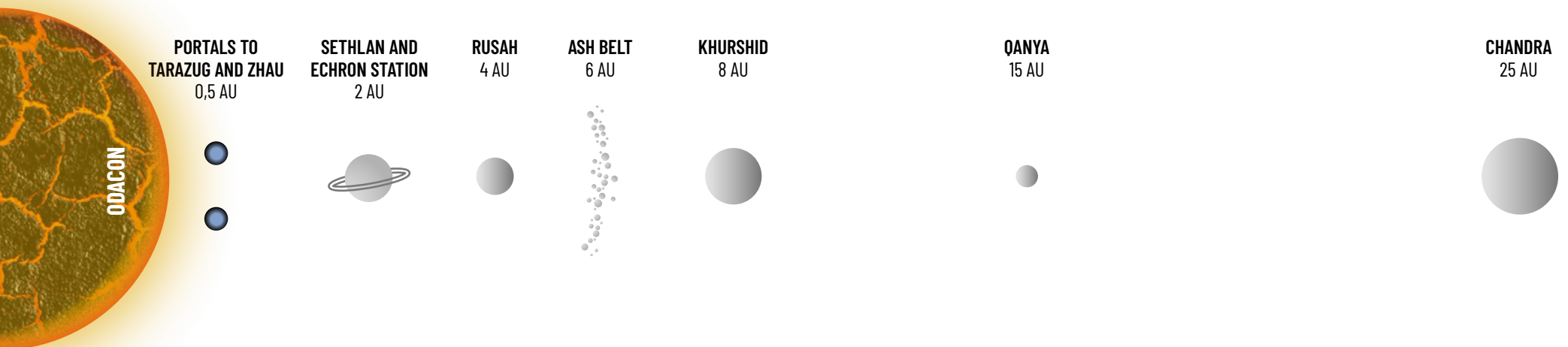
Chandra: The gas planet that has been colored grey by the debris of crashed spaceships.

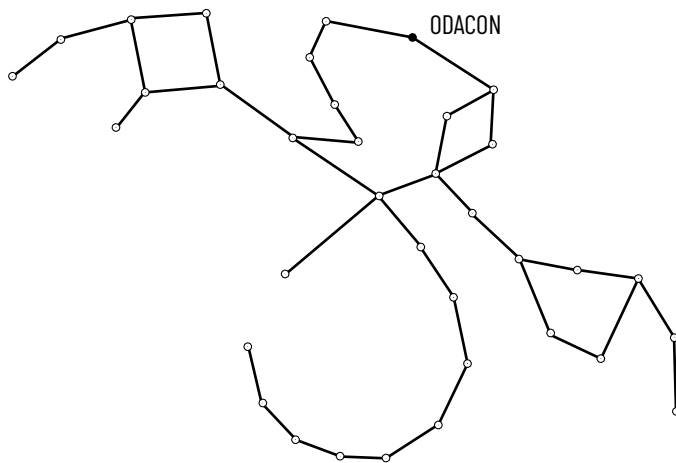
ODACON TODAY

Of all the systems in the Third Horizon, Odacon is the most troubled. The war was not only devastating for the people and their settlements, but also for the celestial bodies in the system. Unimaginable powers of destruction would have fully torn the system apart, were it not for the war having come to an end. Today, none of the official factions of the Horizon have any significant presence in the system. The Consortium regularly passes through along the Miran chain and the Order of the Pariah have a monastery on the planet of Qayna. But beyond these, there are only a few settlements and space stations scattered in the system.

A TORMENTED STAR

The star Odacon is said to have been used as a weapon in the conflict. Persistent rumors claim that a massive structure was built using long lost technology and that it was used to harness the power of the star. Matter from the star is said to have been ejected out in the system, burning away the atmosphere of the planet Rusah. Stubborn fortune seekers still search for remnants of this mythical technology inside the Ash Belt, as well as on the broken surface of Sethlan. To this day, the star is unstable and difficult to predict. It has cooled considerably and creates strange gravitational phenomena in the system. Theories about how its life cycle has been distorted vary greatly.





THE MINING STATION ECHRON

In low orbit around Sethlan lies the mining station Echron, a several kilometers-long and a few hundred meters-wide tube-shaped construction. A giant mass accelerator runs along its entire length. It is a remnant from the Portal Wars when it was used as a launch pad for massive kinetic projectiles, designed to inflict enormous damage on astronomical bodies.

Nowadays Echron serves a very different - but still important - purpose. Given Sethlan's extreme gravity, it is very demanding for heavy freighters to lift the ore unearthed on both the planet and its moons. Instead, it is transported with simple cargo shuttles - essentially platforms with graviton projectors - to Echron. Once there, the ore is loaded into the mass accelerator and then shot out towards waiting freighters in high orbit. The station is kept in low orbit around Sethlan by powerful thrusters salvaged from the Ash Belt. Echron is under control of the Consortium and frequently targeted by the corsairs in the region.

RUSAH - THE EXECUTIONER'S ABODE

Beyond Sethlan is Rusah, now a completely lifeless planetary body with no atmosphere and seemingly nothing of interest. Whispers in dark corners of cantinas claim that Rusah houses the real headquarters of the Draconites, built on remnants from the Portal Builders and full of ancient secrets. The Draconites officially known are but a cover up, the rumors tell you. There are those who believe that even the system's most violent pirates stay off the planet for fear of what might happen to those who invoke the Draconites ire.

THE BANE OF ASHES

Few things can chill the blood of Odacon's residents quite like the mention of the Bane of Ashes. It is an entity said to be able to destroy a ship by simply breaking it down, molecule by molecule. Some say that the Bane of Ashes is a semi-intelligent war machine while others believe it to be a chaotic cloud of nanites. The truth about the Bane has yet to be revealed.

THE ASH BELT

Beyond Rusah, the vast Ash Belt spreads out like a dark veil. It consists of the remains of the planet Matush that was torn apart during the portal wars, as well as the wreckages of the fleets of the Firstcome, Al-ardha and the Second Horizon. The belt is a veritable gold mine for scrap prospectors and adventurers, but it also houses many dangers: in addition to the fabled Bane of Ashes, there are also bloodthirsty corsairs, automated weapon systems and forgotten mines.

Beside the main hub of the ash belt, Khôban station, several small asteroid and micro space station communities have been established in the inner sector of the Ash Belt. These serve as temporary housing for those who explore the belt, but they do not always provide ample protection.

KHÔBAN STATION

The Free League holds some influence in the system, since the bulk of the trade between settlements and space stations is operated by free trader captains. The contracts for these trade routes seldomly attract men and women with good reputations, but rather captains on the verge of turning to piracy or becoming corsairs. Nonetheless, the Free League is a major contract giver for the many prospectors who search for treasures in the Ash Belt or under the frozen soil of Qayna.

The main settlement of the Free League is Khôban station, positioned at the sunward edge of the Ash belt. The old firstcome station has been towed here and jury-rigged with salvaged parts. It is protected by powerful grav-deflectors to keep space debris away from the fragile people it houses.

QAYNA'S GLACIER RUINS

The planet Qayna is covered in ice. Light and heat from the Odacon star is unable to reach the planet, partly because of the long distance, but mostly because the Ash belt is blocking the way. There are still many more or less intact structures on the planet, but the ice covers everything, making them hard to reach. Several very ambitious projects aimed at finding artifacts or valuable resources can be found here, and interest in Qayna's secrets is growing steadily. It is only a matter of time before the planet becomes crowded and conflicts arise.